

PAULT DOCUMENTATION

2026 01 27 Ux Architecture Design

Source: docs/plans/2026-01-27-ux-architecture-design.md

Theme: Clean Technical

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Pault UX Architecture Design

> **Status: COMPLETED** — Menu bar-first architecture implemented. See [2026-01-27-menu-bar-implementation.md](#) for the task-level plan.

Overview

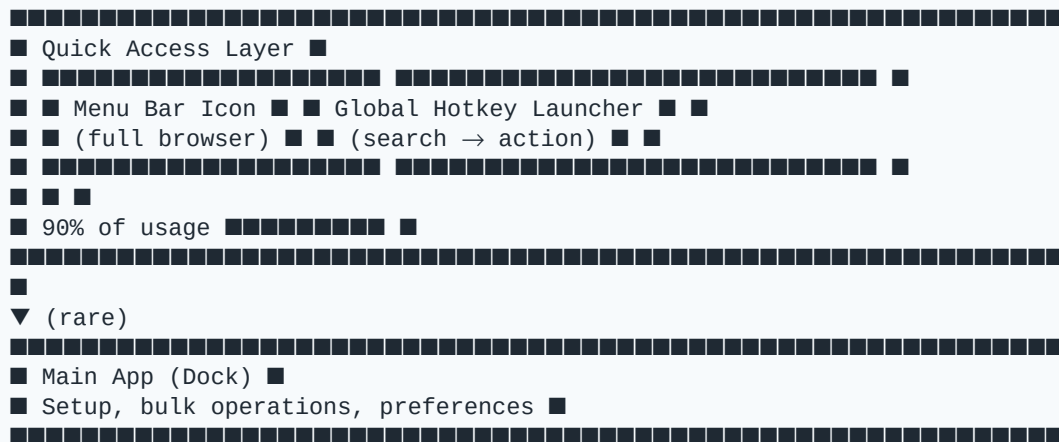
Transform Pault from a dock-based app into a menu bar-first AI prompt library. Quick access handles 90% of usage; the main app becomes a management console for setup and bulk operations.

Core Concept

Pault becomes a menu bar-first application with two quick access methods:

1. **Menu bar popover** — Full mini-browser with search, filters, prompt list, and inline editing
2. **Global hotkey launcher** — Spotlight-style quick search with instant actions

Mental Model



App Lifecycle

- Pault runs as a menu bar app (no dock icon by default)
- Main window can be opened from menu bar or Cmd++, for preferences
- Stays running in background for instant access

Menu Bar Popover

Appearance

A popover window (roughly 320×480pt) anchored to the menu bar icon. Feels native, like macOS's Wi-Fi or Bluetooth popovers but larger.

Layout



[illegible]

Interactions

- **Click prompt** → Expands inline to show full content + action buttons (Copy / Paste / Edit / Open in App)
- **Right-click prompt** → Context menu (Favorite, Archive, Delete)
- **Click tag pill** → Filters list to that tag
- **+ New** → Inline creation form (title, content, tags)
- **Edit mode** → Fields become editable inline, auto-saves on blur

Keyboard Navigation

- Arrow keys navigate list
- Enter on selected prompt → shows options
- Cmd++C copies immediately
- Cmd++V pastes to frontmost app
- Escape closes popover

...

Global Hotkey Launcher

Appearance

A floating panel centered on screen (similar to Spotlight or Raycast). Minimal chrome, appears instantly on hotkey press.

[illegible]

Behavior

- **Default hotkey:** Cmd+++Shift+P (customizable in preferences)
- **Instant fuzzy search** across title, content, and tags
- **Results ranked by:** exact match → favorites → recent use → alphabetical

Selection Flow

When you press Enter (or click) on a prompt:

```
███████████ Email Tone Adjuster ████████████  
████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████  
████ [C Copy] [V Paste] [E Edit] [O Open]████████████████████████████████████████
```

- **Cmd++C** → Copy to clipboard, dismiss
- **Cmd++V** → Copy + paste into frontmost app, dismiss
- **Cmd++E** → Open in menu bar popover for editing
- **Cmd++O** → Open in main app
- **Escape** → Go back to search

Speed Shortcuts

From the search results (without selecting first):

- **Cmd++1 through Cmd++9** → Instantly copy the Nth result

Main App Changes

Role Shift

The main app becomes a "management console" rather than the primary interface. Opens when you need to:

- Bulk edit or reorganize prompts
- Manage tags (rename, merge, delete)
- Import/export library
- Configure preferences

Behavior Changes

- **No dock icon by default** — Pault runs as menu bar agent
- **Open via:** Menu bar → Settings → "Open Main Window", or Cmd++, from anywhere
- **Closing main window** doesn't quit — app stays in menu bar

Preferences

Setting	Options
1. General	- Language: English - Units: Metric - Time Zone: UTC-5
2. Security	- Two-Factor Authentication: Enabled - Password Complexity: Strong - Session Timeout: 30 minutes
3. Performance	- Caching: Enabled - Database Optimization: On - Log Level: Info
4. Integration	- API Key: sk-1234567890 - Webhook URL: https://example.com/webhook - OAuth2: Enabled

| Global hotkey | Customizable (default Cmd++Shift+P) |

| Launch at login | On/Off |

| Show dock icon | On/Off |

| Default action | Copy / Paste / Show options |

| Paste delay | 0-500ms (for apps that need it) |

Main Window Focus

Since quick access handles browsing/editing, the main app focuses on:

- **Library view** — Table/grid of all prompts with bulk selection
- **Tag manager** — Dedicated view for organizing tags
- **Import/Export** — Backup and restore
- **Preferences** — All settings in one place

Implementation Summary

New Components to Build

Component	Description
PaultMenuBarApp	Menu bar agent with NSPopover
MenuBarPopover	Full browser view (search, filters, list, inline editing)
HotkeyLauncher	Floating panel with fuzzy search
GlobalHotkeyManager	Registers and handles system-wide hotkey
PasteService	Simulates paste into frontmost app
PreferencesView	Settings for hotkey, launch at login, etc.

Technical Considerations

- **Menu bar app:** Use NSStatusItem + NSPopover for native feel
- **Global hotkey:** Use CGEvent tap or a library like HotKey
- **Paste simulation:** CGEvent to send Cmd++V to frontmost app
- **App lifecycle:** LSUIElement = YES in Info.plist to hide dock icon

Migration Path

1. Keep current main app working
2. Add menu bar agent alongside
3. Add global hotkey launcher
4. Add preferences to control behavior
5. Default to menu bar-first for new users

Data Model Changes

No changes to existing Prompt and Tag models. Additions:

- `lastUsedAt`: Date on Prompt for "recent" sorting in launcher
- User preferences stored in `UserDefaults` or a `Settings` model

Summary

| Layer | Purpose | Access |

|-----|-----|-----|

| Menu bar popover | Full browser, inline editing | Click menu bar icon |

| Hotkey launcher | Fast search → action | Cmd++Shift+P |

| Main app | Management, settings, bulk ops | Rarely opened |